

Rollout & Evidence Plan

Objective Roll out a high-impact data platform change safely while generating enough evidence at each stage to decide whether to **proceed, adjust, or pause**.

1. Representative cohorts, bounded exposure

Customers are grouped into staged cohorts using **stratified sampling**, rather than simple account counts. Cohorts balance customer segment and use case, commercial exposure, product usage and dependency, and higher-risk or strategically important customers.

Each cohort approximates the broader customer mix while limiting total exposure. The first cohort is intentionally small enough to contain downside but diverse enough to generate meaningful signal.

Representative enough to learn. Small enough to recover.

2. Communication is part of the rollout

Customer communication is treated as a product surface, not a launch afterthought. For each cohort, define:

Who is affected → What changes → When → Expected impact → Available actions → Support path

Communication and rollout operate on a staggered cadence. While one cohort is being observed, the next can be prepared without stopping the entire rollout unless predefined guardrails are breached.

3. Separate populations with different risk profiles

Populations with materially different product behavior, contractual expectations, or technical dependencies follow a **separate rollout track**. Their exposure, communication, metrics, and decisions are evaluated independently rather than allowing one population to distort the baseline.

4. Evidence gates determine progression

Launch → Observe → Evaluate evidence → Proceed / Adjust / Pause → Next cohort

Evidence	What we evaluate
Customer	Support volume, complaints, feedback themes
Product	Usage changes, affected workflows, unexpected behavior
System	Errors, latency, regressions, operational health
Business	Commercial exposure, cost impact, retention risk
Guardrails	High-value customer impact, incidents, threshold breaches

Success criteria and stop conditions are defined **before launch**, preventing rollout decisions from being driven by anecdotal reactions after the fact.

Decision Framework

PROCEED Metrics remain within guardrails and no material new risk emerges.	ADJUST Evidence reveals a contained issue with a viable mitigation.	PAUSE Customer, system, or business guardrails are breached.
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Operating principle: Optimize for reversible learning early; increase exposure only as evidence increases confidence.